

Willa Wei



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<https://willawei624.github.io/>

I'm an Illustrator/UX designer.

EDUCATION

2017.09-2022.5

RINGLING COLLEGE OF ART & DESIGN

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Illustration (With Honors)

2025.09-NOW

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON

Master of Human Centered Design & Engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

CHARACTER DESIGNER

CHANGSHA, HN

2021.06-2021.11

SHUPIAN INDIVIDUAL STUDIO

- Designed 20+ characters for clients, offering diverse options and tailored advice, increasing client satisfaction by 15%.
- Created 10+ posters, delivering design solutions and layouts that boosted client market exposure by 20%.

ACCOUNT MANAGER INTERN

CHANGSHA, HN

2024.04-2024.05

CHINA CONSTRUCTION BANK CORPORATION

- Assisted Account Managers in enhancing customer satisfaction by supporting the sale of financial products and client services.
- Contributed to risk assessment and loan approvals, aiding in the successful approval of loans exceeding ¥300,000.

PROJECT EXPERIENCES

UX DESIGNER

REMOTE

2024.08-2025.03

PAWPAL

- Took complete ownership and accountability on designing a pet-care mobile app focused on reducing separation anxiety through end-to-end user entered design process.
- Conducted user research and usability testings to identify and narrow down user pain points and needs about the separation anxiety.
- Constructed the design system of PAIPAW to facilitate the efficiency of design.

UX/UI DESIGNER, VISUAL STORYTELLER

SEATTLE, WA

2025.09-2025.12

TRU WELLNESS PODS

- Engineered an integrated solution (physical space + digital booking) to address the lack of private rest areas for University of Washington students during 30-60 minute gaps between classes.
- Designed high-fidelity prototypes in Figma for a mobile booking app and in-pod Kiosk, featuring multilingual support, voice assistance, and customizable massage modes for accessibility.
- Produced a comprehensive 28-page Design Specification including personas, design rationale, and a strategic roadmap for commercial scalability.

UX RESEARCHER

SEATTLE, WA

2026.01-2025.03

COLLEAGUE AI. USABILITY TESTING

- Led end-to-end usability evaluation for a EdTech startup (Colleague AI), identifying systemic UI/UX flaws within the teacher-facing management dashboard.
- Utilized heuristic evaluation and severity-based classification to prioritize 10+ usability roadblocks, providing the engineering and design teams with a clear optimization roadmap.
- Authored a 40-page technical research specification that guided the redesign of the instructor workflow, successfully lowering operational barriers and enhancing overall user efficiency.

SKILLS

DESIGN

Persona
User Journey Map
Information
User Flow
Information Architecture
UI Design
Wireframing
Prototyping
Cover Design
Character Design
Handmade Doll Design

USER RESEARCH

Interview
Survey
Competitive Analysis
Data Analytics
Field Study
Market Research

TOOLS

Figma
Adobe Illustrator
Photoshop
Procreate
3DS Max
ZBrush
Nomad
Gen AI

LANGUAGE

English
Mandarin

